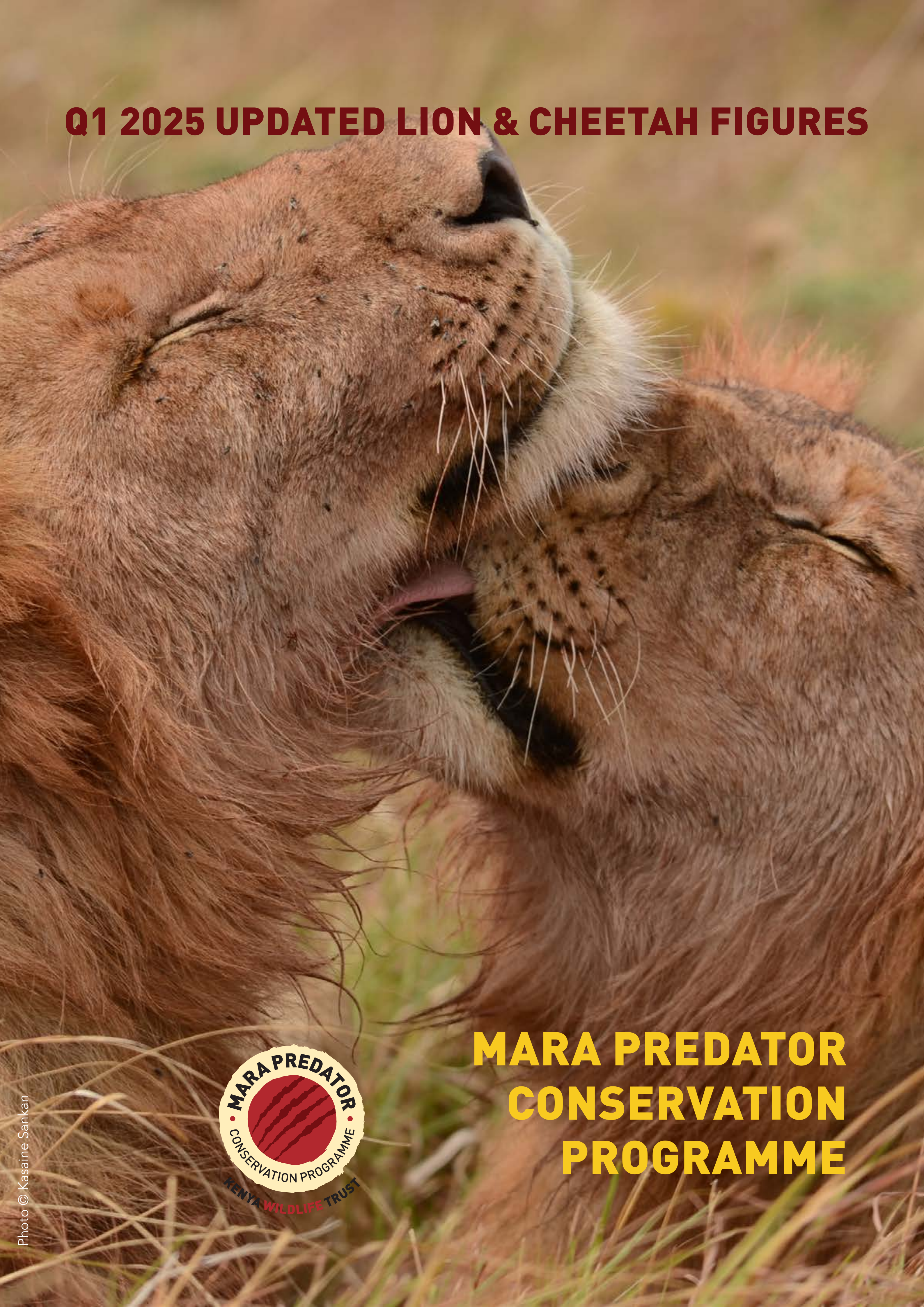
Q1 2025 UPDATED LION & CHEETAH FIGURES



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MARA PREDATOR CONSERVATION PROGRAMME

We are pleased to present updated lion and cheetah figures from the 2024 survey period, which spanned from August 1 to October 31. This is our 11th consecutive year of providing accurate density estimates of lions and cheetahs.

Lions

New lion figures

Table 1 shows estimates for lion density, abundance, and sex ratio for lions over the age of one year in the Maasai Mara (National Reserve and the surrounding wildlife conservancies) for 2023 and 2024. We have been conducting consecutive annual lion surveys in the Maasai Mara since 2014. Our study area has increased over the years, which has enabled us to calculate lion densities over a larger area.

We have identified fluctuations in lion population size and spatial distribution trends. This year's results are very similar to the previous year's estimate, with a minor decrease from 16.7 to 16.5 lions > 1 year/100 km^2

Lions	2023	2024
Study area (km^2)	2,713	2,713
Lion Density	16.7	16.5
Lion Abundance	480	465
Sex ratio (F:M)	2.1	1.76

Table 1: Lion density is given as lions/100km^2 > 1-year-old, lion abundance is lions > 1 year old, sex ratio is female to male

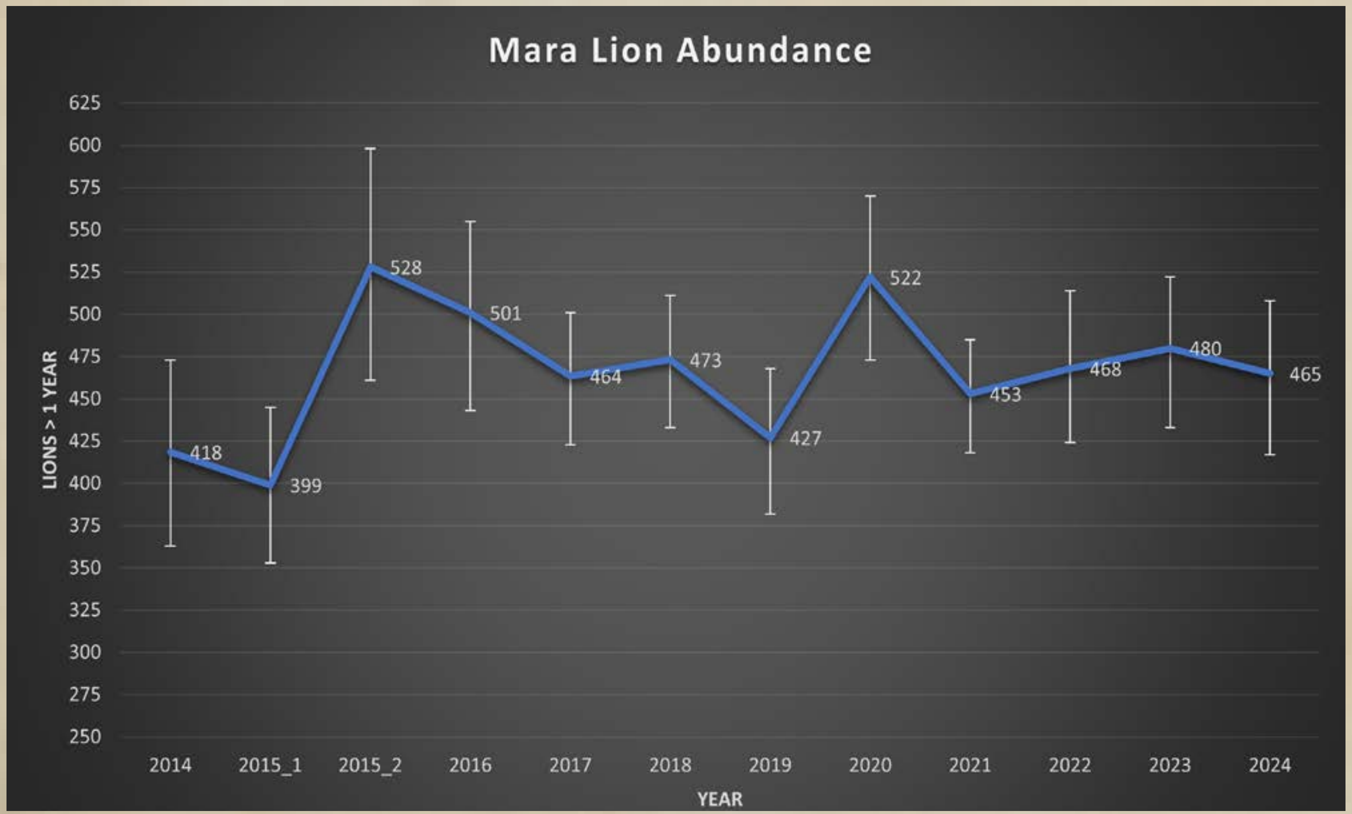

Figure 1. Mara lion abundance from 2014-2024. NB! 2015 figures are preliminary. Error bars represent the upper and lower limits.

Table 2 shows lion density and abundance for the respective management units.

Wildlife area	Abundance		Density	
	2023	2024	2023	2024
Enonkishu	5	5	19.96	18.38
Lemek	11	16	18.71	25.75
Mara North	51	50	17.25	17.07
Naboisho	47	33	22.86	15.88
Olarro North	2	3	6.29	10.03
Ripoi	4	9	6.69	16.70
Ol Chorro	5	6	8.33	10.53
Olderikesi	4	4	9.85	10.38
Ol Kinyei	21	15	31.34	22.57
Olare-Motorogi	36	36	24.20	24.09
Siana	3	4	7.8	10.89
Isaaten	1	2	5.7	8.72
Nashulai	6	3	15.54	7.47
Olerai	2	2	16.82	12.95
Oloisukut	14	13	14.56	12.87
Mara Triangle	92	71	19.28	14.42
MMNR	178	195	16.94	18.51

Table 2: Lion abundance > 1 year and density > 1year/100km2 for the different management units for 2023 vs 2024

During our survey period, Lemek Conservancy had the highest lion density, followed by Olare Motorogi Conservancy and Ol Kinyei Conservancy. These three conservancies all had densities over 20 lions > 1 year/100 km2.

The 2024 lion densities can be viewed as a heat map as shown in figure 2.

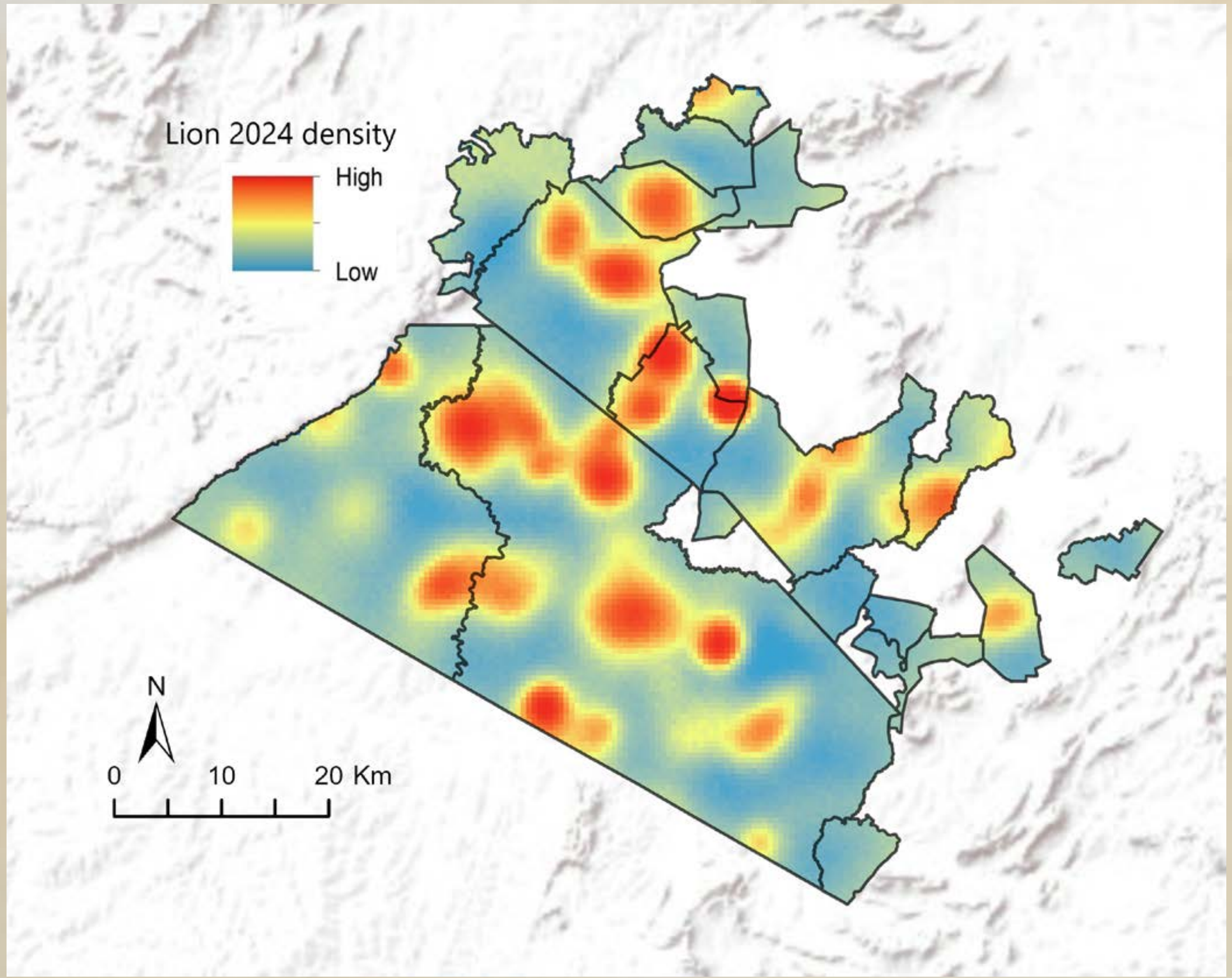

Figure 2. Lion density heat map.

The 2024 lion survey confirms that the population within our study area remains stable, with an estimated density of 16.5 lions per 100 km², nearly identical to the 2023 estimate. This stability is a positive indicator of the effectiveness of ongoing conservation efforts. Many community conservancies surveyed support lion densities comparable to those in the Maasai Mara National Reserve, underscoring their important role in maintaining habitat connectivity and contributing to lion conservation.

The value of long-term monitoring is evident, as this eleventh consecutive survey provides a strong foundation for detecting trends and informing management. The spatially explicit nature of the data further enables targeted conservation action, such as addressing conflict hotspots or planning community outreach. Continued financial and institutional support will be essential to maintain and build on these successes.

Cheetahs

New cheetah figures

Table 3 shows estimates for cheetah density, abundance and sex ratio for independent resident adult cheetahs in the Masai Mara (National Reserve and the surrounding wildlife conservancies) for 2023 and 2024.

Resident independent cheetahs	2023	2024
Study area (km²)	2,713	2,713
Cheetah Density	1.03	0.44
Cheetah Abundance	28	12
Sex ratio (M:F)	0.82	0.55

Table 3: Cheetah density is given as independent individuals/100km2, cheetah abundance is for independent individuals, sex ratio is females to males.

The table reveals a notable decline in the resident Mara cheetah population, with a more than 50% drop in abundance. It is important to note that this number reflects the cheetahs that were resident during the survey period, August to October, and does not include transient cheetahs who pass through the system and cheetahs who are partial residents.

The total number of cheetahs using the Mara over an entire year is much higher than these provided figure. Regardless, the resident Mara cheetah population is at an all-time low, and we are losing our adult females, as is reflected by the low female-to-male sex ratio (figure 3).

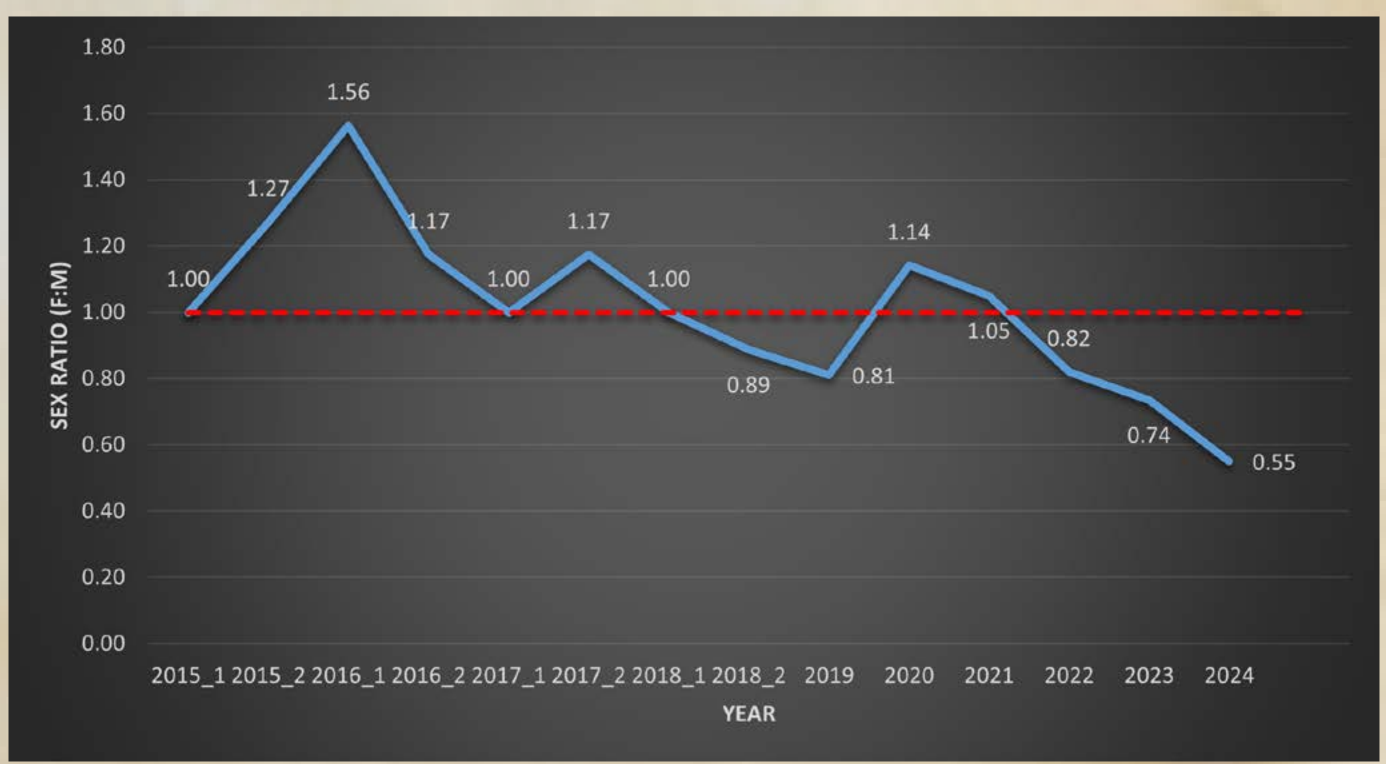

Figure 3. This graph shows the number of female to male cheetahs. It is evident that there is a downward trend of fewer adult females in the Mara.

We have conducted a comprehensive analysis of cheetah densities spanning the years 2014 to 2024, including biannual surveys from 2015 to 2018, as depicted in Figure 4. The availability of long-term datasets is paramount for examining population trends effectively. It is important to recognise that due to the inherently low population densities of cheetahs, coupled with small sample sizes, any sudden increase or decrease in cheetah numbers, such as during a disease outbreak, can lead to significant fluctuations within the population.

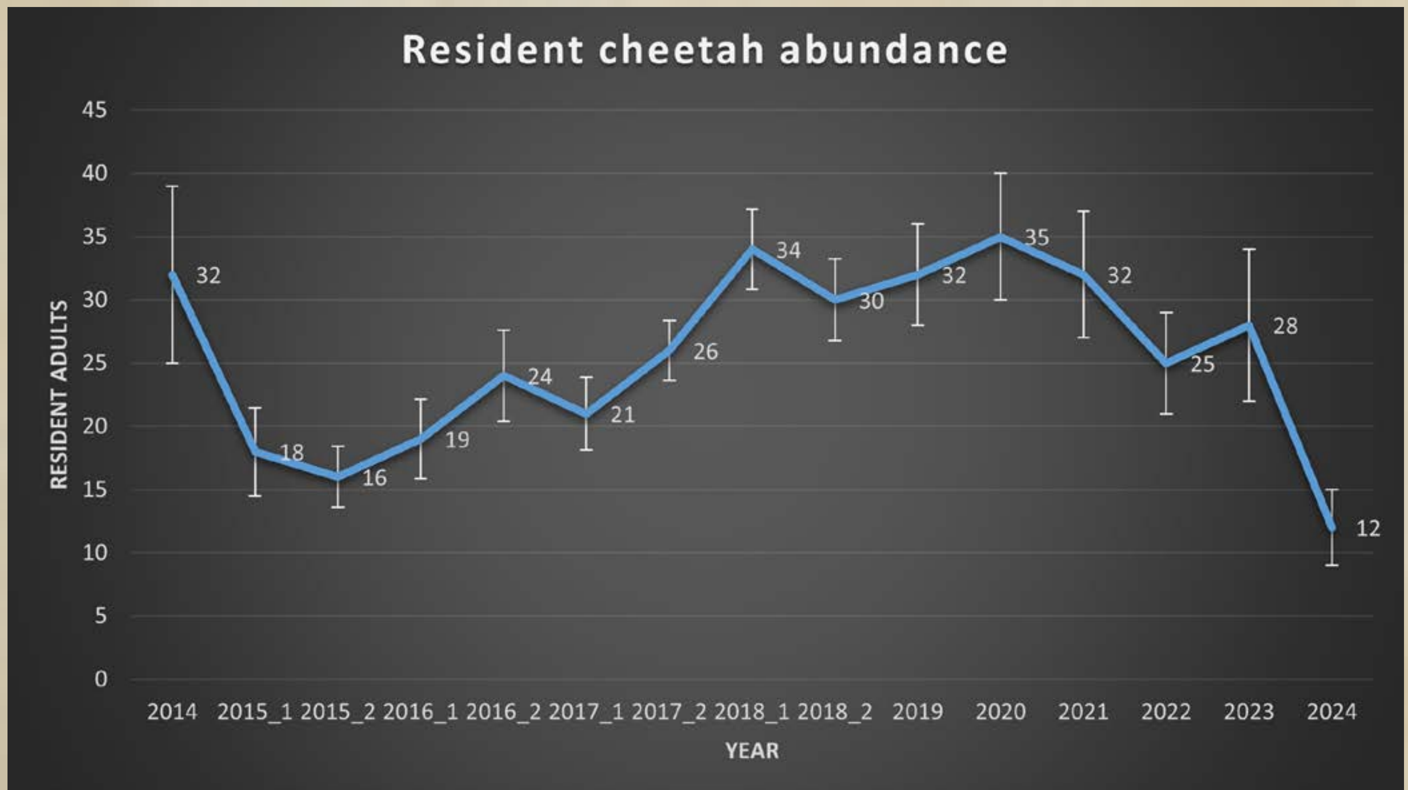

Figure 4: This graph shows cheetah abundance (error bars represent standard deviations) from 2014-2024. There was one survey in 2014 and from 2019-2023 (01August-31October), and two surveys in 2015-2018 (01February-30April & 01August-31October).

As with the lion data, we have produced a cheetah density heat map illustrated in Figure 5.

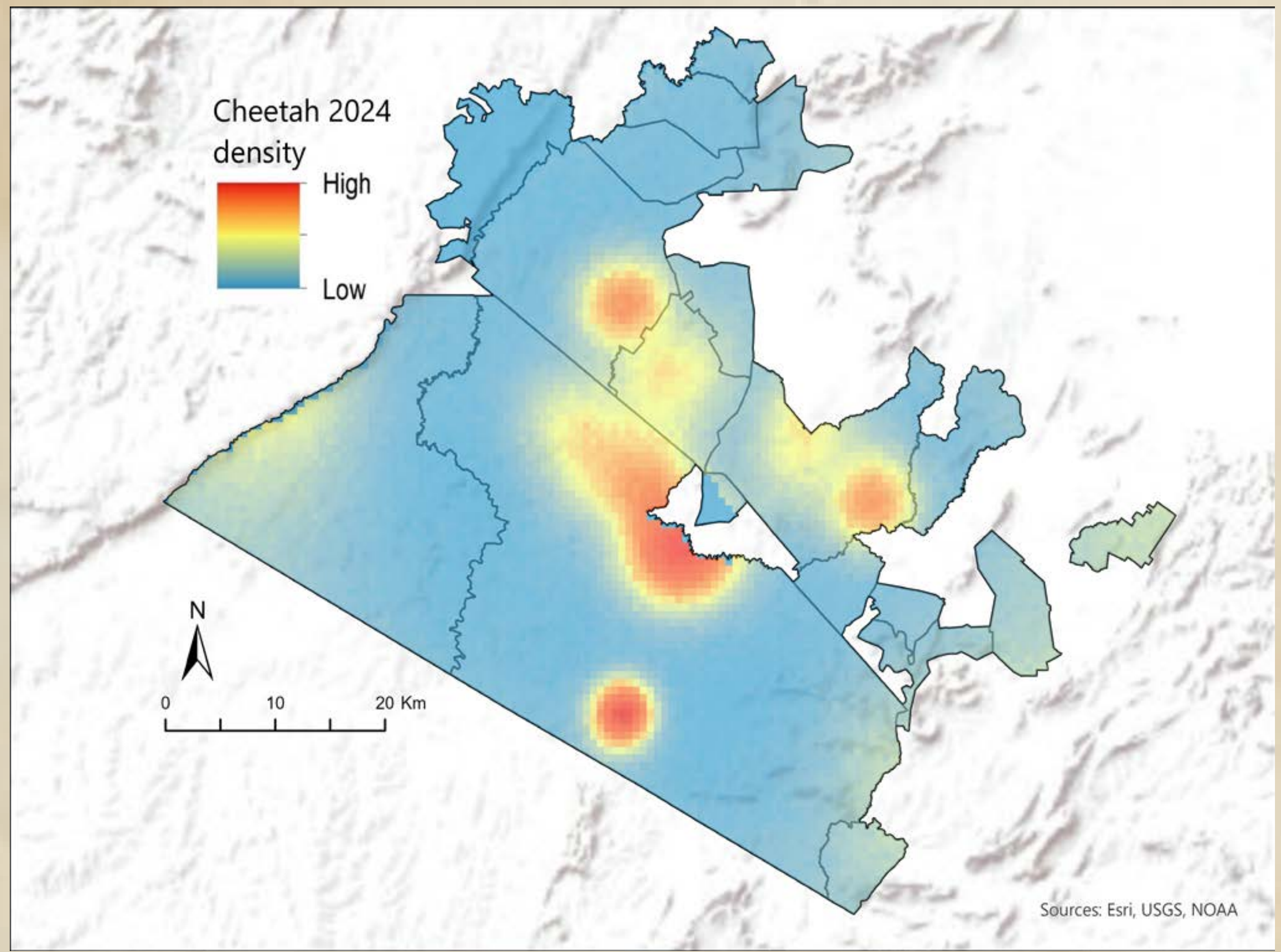

Figure 5. Cheetah density heatmap

Mara Predator Conservation Programme
info@marapredatorconservation.org | www.marapredatorconservation.org

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